

AFRICAN AI STARTUP RESEARCH PROJECT

Project Overview & Research Framework — 2026

A structured research framework for identifying, verifying and organizing information on African AI-focused companies and publicly available funding intelligence.

Research sample	50 companies
Research fields	20 per company
Primary output	Source-verified research dataset
Research focus	AI companies + funding intelligence

1. Project Overview

This project builds a source-verified research dataset of African AI-focused companies, combining company intelligence with publicly available funding information.

The dataset provides a structured view of companies operating across African markets, including location, founding year, AI focus, industry, products or services, target markets, business models, funding stages, publicly disclosed funding, investors and supporting sources.

The resulting research asset is intended for market research, competitor research, business development, investment research and strategic analysis.

2. Research Objective

The objective is to build a reliable dataset that allows company-level AI and funding information to be compared within a consistent research structure while retaining the source trail behind important claims.

The research deliberately avoids filling gaps with assumptions. Information that cannot be reliably established remains missing or is documented as an unresolved research issue.

3. Research Questions

1. Which African countries have the largest number of identified AI-focused companies?
2. Which cities or technology hubs appear most frequently?
3. What AI technologies and applications are represented?
4. Which industries are being served?
5. What products and services are being offered?
6. Who are the primary target customers or markets?
7. What business models are being used?
8. What funding stages are represented?
9. Which companies have publicly disclosed recent funding?
10. What funding rounds and lead investors have been publicly reported?

4. Research Population & Inclusion Criteria

The population consists of African AI-focused companies founded in Africa or substantially operating in African markets.

- AI is a meaningful component of the product, service or core technology.
- A publicly identifiable product, service or business activity exists.
- The company has a documented connection to an African country or African market.
- Sufficient public information is available to establish the company's identity and key details.
- Relevant company or funding information can be supported by reliable public sources.

Exclusion criteria

- Companies with no meaningful AI component.
- AI companies with no verifiable connection to African markets.
- Individuals, projects, academic laboratories or research papers without a company-level business.
- Companies for which basic identity or operating information cannot be reliably verified.

- Duplicate entries representing the same company.

5. Information Collected

Field	Research purpose
Company_Name	Identifies the company being researched.
Country	Records the primary African country associated with the company.
City	Captures the identified operating or headquarters city.
Founded_Year	Records the publicly supported founding year.
AI_Focus	Classifies the principal AI application or technology.
Industry	Identifies the main sector served.
Product_or_Service	Summarizes the core offering.
Target_Market	Describes primary customer or market groups.
Business_Model	Records the identified commercial model.
Funding_Stage	Classifies the relevant financing stage.
Total_Funding_USD	Records numeric publicly disclosed funding where established.
Latest_Funding_Date	Records the latest identified funding date.
Latest_Round	Records the latest identified financing event.
Lead_Investor	Records the lead investor where identifiable.
Website	Primary company web presence.
LinkedIn	Company LinkedIn presence where identified.
Funding_Source	Source supporting funding information.
Company_Source	Source supporting company information.
Verification_Status	Indicates evidence completeness/reliability.
Research_Notes	Documents context, conflicts and research decisions.

6. Source & Verification Framework

Tier 1 — Primary sources: official company websites, official announcements, company LinkedIn pages, investor/funding announcements and applicable corporate or regulatory filings.

Tier 2 — Reputable secondary sources: established technology and business publications, reputable startup and venture databases, industry research reports and recognized African technology/business publications.

Tier 3 — Discovery sources: startup directories, search results, aggregators and social posts used primarily to identify leads. Important claims should be strengthened with higher-quality evidence where possible.

7. Verification Approach

Company information and funding information are verified separately. Company review covers identity, location, founding year, AI focus, industry, product/service, target market and business model. Funding review covers stage, disclosed amount, latest date, latest round and lead investor.

When sources conflict, the research compares dates, context and definitions. Recent primary sources receive greater weight where appropriate. Unresolved differences are documented rather than silently

overwritten.

8. Funding Data Rule

Only publicly disclosed funding amounts are recorded as numeric values. Funding is not estimated from company valuation, investor ownership, unverified database figures, rumours or undisclosed deal terms.

When a reliable amount cannot be established, the funding field remains blank and relevant context is retained in the research record.

9. Verification Status Definitions

Status	Definition
Verified	Key company information and relevant funding information have sufficient supporting evidence.
Partially Verified	Core company information is supported, but one or more important fields require additional verification.
Needs Review	Important information remains uncertain, conflicting or insufficiently supported.

10. Data Quality Rules

- No invented information or unsupported funding estimates.
- No duplicate company records.
- Missing information is preserved rather than replaced with assumptions.
- Descriptions are standardized without changing the underlying meaning.
- Funding dates and numeric amounts follow consistent formats.
- Controlled categorical values are used consistently.
- Company and funding sources are recorded separately.
- Conflicting or unresolved information is documented in Research_Notes.
- Final records are reviewed before inclusion in the master dataset.

11. Research Workflow

1. Identify potentially relevant African AI-focused companies.
2. Screen candidates against the inclusion criteria.
3. Collect company-level information.
4. Research publicly disclosed funding.
5. Record supporting company and funding sources.
6. Investigate conflicting or incomplete information.
7. Standardize the dataset.
8. Validate duplicates, missing fields and categorical consistency.
9. Analyze the completed research sample.
10. Prepare the final dataset and client-facing reports.

12. Final Deliverables

Deliverable	Role in the project
African_AI_Startup_Research.xlsx	Primary structured research dataset.
African_AI_Startup_Research.csv	Portable dataset for analysis and import into other tools.
Research_Summary.pdf	Client-facing findings and market/funding overview.
Project_Overview.pdf	Research framework, methodology and verification documentation.
Data_Research_Portfolio.ipynb	Technical evidence of data handling, validation and analysis.

13. Intended Use

The dataset can support competitor research, market mapping, business development, investment screening, partnership research, sector analysis and further data analysis.

Because the research is based on public information, users should consult the underlying source fields when making decisions that depend on current company or funding details.